



HOW TO PLAY

winter memories

Start Here: Leading Winter Activities

Who this is for

Caregivers, activity directors, and families sharing the winter months with an older adult. Every activity is low prep, needs only the printout and a kind voice, and works one on one or with a small group.

How to lead it

Read slowly and leave plenty of room to answer. In the conversation activities there are no wrong answers, only stories worth hearing. For the quizzes, offer gentle hints and celebrate every try. Twenty or thirty minutes is plenty for one sitting.

A gentle note

Winter and the holidays can bring bittersweet memories as well as happy ones. Follow the person's lead. If a memory brings warmth, linger there. If a topic feels heavy, move on to the next card. Connection is the whole goal.





CONVERSATION

winter memories

Remember When: Winters Gone By

Read one prompt at a time and give the person plenty of room to answer.
Follow the story wherever it leads. These are doors into warm memories,
not tests of recall.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ What did the first snowfall of the year feel like when you were young | ☐ What chores had to be done before a big snow came |
| ☐ Tell me about walking to school on a cold winter morning | ☐ Tell me about a winter coat or a pair of boots you remember |
| ☐ Did you ever go sledding, and where did you go | ☐ What did the mornings sound like after a heavy snow |
| ☐ How did your family keep the house warm in winter | ☐ Did your family travel in winter, and how did you get there |
| ☐ What did you wear to stay warm as a child | ☐ What did you do on a long dark evening before bed |
| ☐ Tell me about a winter storm you will never forget | ☐ Tell me about a fire, a stove, or a radiator you remember well |
| ☐ Did you ever make a snowman or a snow angel | ☐ What was the coldest you have ever been |
| ☐ What did you and the other children do outside in the cold | ☐ What did winter smell like in your house |
| ☐ What was the best thing to come inside to after playing in the snow | ☐ Who did you spend the winter months with |
| ☐ Did you ever go ice skating or sliding on a frozen pond | ☐ What is your happiest memory of a winter long ago |





QUIZ

winter memories

Finish the Familiar Winter Saying

Read the first half of each well known saying out loud and let the group call out the ending. Say it together and share what the saying means to you. Answers are on the leader key.

1. Where there is smoke, there is...

.....

2. Cold hands, warm...

.....

3. Snug as a bug in a...

.....

4. Every cloud has a silver...

.....

5. Come in from the...

.....

6. Bundle up, it is cold...

.....

7. The calm before the...

.....

8. White as...

.....

9. Home is where the heart...

.....

10. Many hands make light...

.....

11. There is no place like...

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12. Save it for a rainy...

.....

13. Good things come to those who...

.....

14. It is the thought that...

.....





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Finish the Familiar Winter Saying: Leader Answer Key

Answers 1 to 7

1. Fire. 2. Heart. 3. Rug. 4. Lining. 5. Cold. 6. Outside. 7. Storm.

Answers 8 to 14

8. Snow. 9. Is. 10. Work. 11. Home. 12. Day. 13. Wait. 14. Counts. Accept any warm answer that fits.





CONVERSATION

winter memories

Remember When: Holidays at Home

Continue the conversation with these prompts about holidays and gatherings. Let the person take the lead and enjoy the memories together.

- ☐ What holidays did your family celebrate in the winter
- ☐ Tell me about a holiday meal you remember
- ☐ Who did the cooking, and what was their specialty
- ☐ What did the house look like when it was decorated
- ☐ Did you help put up the decorations
- ☐ What was the best gift you ever received
- ☐ What was a gift you gave that you were proud of
- ☐ Tell me about a holiday when the whole family came
- ☐ Did you sing, play music, or listen to the radio together
- ☐ What did the children do while the grown ups talked
- ☐ Was there a special dish only made once a year
- ☐ Tell me about a holiday tradition your family kept
- ☐ Did you go to a service, a gathering, or a party
- ☐ What did you wear for a special occasion
- ☐ Who always made everyone laugh at the table
- ☐ What did you do with the leftovers
- ☐ Tell me about a card or a letter that meant something
- ☐ What did you look forward to most as a child
- ☐ Is there a tradition you passed on to your own family
- ☐ What made a holiday feel truly special to you





QUIZ

winter memories

Winter and Holiday Trivia

Read each question out loud and let the group answer together. Offer hints and celebrate every good guess. This is for smiles and conversation, so accept any close answer. The leader key follows.

1. What do we call frozen water that falls softly from the sky?

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2. What do you build with three round balls of snow, a hat and a scarf?

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3. What warm drink is made with chocolate and hot milk?

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4. What do we call the pointed pieces of ice that hang from a roof?

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5. What season comes after autumn?

.....

6. What do you wear on your hands to keep them warm?

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7. What holiday marks the very start of a new year?

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8. What animal is said to pull a sleigh through the snow?

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9. What do we call a heavy snowstorm with strong wind?

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10. What tool do you use to clear snow from a path?

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11. What are the songs called that people sing at the holidays?

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12. What do we call the shortest day of the year?

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13. What forms on a cold window and can be scraped with a fingernail?

.....

14. What do we call a ride in a horse drawn sleigh over the snow?

.....





HOW TO PLAY

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Winter and Holiday Trivia: Leader Answer Key



Answers 1 to 7

1. Snow. 2. A snowman. 3. Hot chocolate, or cocoa. 4. Icicles. 5. Winter. 6. Mittens or gloves. 7. New Year's Day.

Answers 8 to 14

8. Reindeer. 9. A blizzard. 10. A shovel. 11. Carols. 12. The winter solstice, the shortest day. 13. Frost or ice. 14. A sleigh ride. Accept any close or reasonable answer.





THIS OR THAT

winter memories

Winter Favorites: This or That

Read each pair and ask which one the person prefers or remembers best.
There is no right answer. Each pair is a doorway to a story about winters past.

Hot chocolate *or* Hot tea

Mittens *or* Gloves

A snowy day *or* A clear cold day

Sledding *or* Watching from the window

A wool blanket *or* A warm fire

Soup on the stove *or* Bread in the oven

Decorating the house *or* Watching it get decorated

Giving gifts *or* Receiving gifts

A big family gathering *or* A quiet evening in

Snow boots *or* Warm slippers

Carols and music *or* Quiet conversation

A long winter walk *or* A cozy armchair

Roast dinner *or* Sandwiches and leftovers

An early sunset *or* A bright frosty morning

Ice skating *or* Sitting by the fire

First snow *or* First thaw





BINGO

winter memories

Signs of Winter Bingo

Give everyone a card. Call out or look for each sign of the season, and mark a square when you spot it or remember it. Five in a row wins, and a full card wins a round of applause. A cheerful way to pass a cold afternoon together.

A snowflake	A pair of mittens	A cup of cocoa	A woolly hat	An icicle
A warm scarf	A snowman	A crackling fire	A quilt or blanket	A pair of boots
A frosty window	A bowl of soup	FREE	A candle	A bare tree
A robin or winter bird	A snow shovel	A holiday card	A cozy armchair	A pot of tea
A knitted sweater	Falling snow	A warm oven	A sled	An early sunset





GROUP GAME

winter memories

Name Something: Winter Edition

Read a category and go around the group naming one thing that fits.
Keep going until the group runs out. A gentle, cheerful way to keep minds
active and voices in the room.

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|--|---|
| ☐ Name something warm you would wear outside | ☐ Name something you would give as a gift |
| ☐ Name a food that warms you up | ☐ Name a tool for clearing snow or ice |
| ☐ Name something you would see on a snowy day | ☐ Name something cozy for a cold night |
| ☐ Name a way to keep the house warm | ☐ Name a place you would rather be in winter |
| ☐ Name something you would drink on a cold evening | ☐ Name something you would bring to a family dinner |
| ☐ Name a game to play indoors | ☐ Name a sound you would hear on a winter evening |
| ☐ Name something you would find in a winter kitchen | ☐ Name something that melts |
| ☐ Name a bird that stays through the winter | ☐ Name a warm color |
| ☐ Name something you would do with children in the snow | ☐ Name something you would put on a table for guests |
| ☐ Name a holiday tradition | ☐ Name something you look forward to in spring |





My Winter Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 1 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their memories to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

My favorite thing about winter as a child

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

The house I grew up in, come winter

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

How we kept warm in those days

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

A winter storm I will never forget

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TOLD BY:





My Winter Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 2 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their memories to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

The holidays we celebrated, and how

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

The person who did the holiday cooking

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

**A holiday meal that still makes my mouth
water**

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

The best gift I ever received

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TOLD BY:





My Winter Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 3 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their memories to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

A gift I was proud to give

TOLD BY: _____

advice & wishes

A tradition our family kept every year

TOLD BY: _____

advice & wishes

The people around our table

TOLD BY: _____

advice & wishes

Something I did outside in the snow

TOLD BY: _____





My Winter Memories Keepsake Cards • Sheet 4 of 4

Write the person's answers on each card as they talk, or hand them the pen if they like. Keep the cards together as a small keepsake of their memories to treasure and share with family.

advice & wishes

A song, a sound, or a smell that means winter to me

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

Something the cold months taught me

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

A perfect winter day, from morning to night

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TOLD BY:

advice & wishes

A wish I have for my family this winter

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TOLD BY:

